

FROM POLITICIANS, ACADEMICS, activists and artists to industry captains, thought leaders and social media influencers, the India Today State of the State Chhattisgarh First Conclave, which was held in Raipur on September 30, was a vibrant affair that brought together people from various spheres to discuss a common theme: the roadmap for Chhattisgarh's progress.

The day-long event began with INDIA TODAY Group Editorial Director Raj Chengappa's introductory remarks. Speaking in the first half, Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel talked about his 'Chhattisgarh Model of Development' and described it as a more

CHHATTISGARHSPEAK

BHUPESH BAGHEL, Chhattisgarh chief minister

Every citizen in Chhattisgarh has an equal right to the resources in the state. Over the last five years, 40 lakh people out of a population of 3 crore have shed the BPL status

The difference between the Gujarat Model and the Chhattisgarh Model is that in the latter, the money from the state's coffers goes to common people: women SHGs, labourers, farmers, the unemployed

Under the FRBM Act, we are below the fiscal deficit limit of 3 per cent of GDP. Our debt, which can be a maximum of 25 per cent of GDP, is 16 per cent. Chhattisgarh meets all standards set by the RBI and Centre

Most coal mines are owned by the SECL, the mines are operated by central government officials.... If there are wrongdoings, why don't they (probe agencies) question central officials?

The ED is threatening people, making them sign confessions. Despite everything, they haven't been able to produce evidence of assets beyond Rs 200 crore. They are doing this to malign the government

I'm not scared of being arrested or killed. Those scared of losing their chair can be worried, not me... Raman Singh as CM had ordered my arrest. The BJP's 15-year rule was reduced to 15 seats

Why should people vote for us? Because we did what we said we would. Under us, workers get their due respect. We have the confidence of the people

How scared are they (BJP) of the INDIA alliance? They even changed the name from 'president of India' to 'president of Bharat'. Why are they so scared?